

approached by Google soon after to make the first ever Nexus tablet. The truth is, it was a planned collaboration by Nvidia, Google and Asus to push for high quality tablets around the \$199 mark (about half the price of an iPad so to speak), and it had been in progress for much longer than the 4 months it took from the ME370T unveiling at CES 2012 to the Nexus 7's release in July of the same year.



Extra holes for extra grip

The Nexus 7 had a 7 inch screen (obviously) with a resolution of 1200\*800, giving a pixel density of 216 ppi. It was heavily inspired by the ME370T, and featured almost the same design elements. It had a different, texturized rubber back, pockmarked with 'dimples' to enhance grippability. The screen also was fully laminated, meaning that there wasn't any air between the layers of glass, to increase color accuracy and improve touch responsiveness – a move that wasn't common for a device at the

price point. On the inside, the impressively powerful Nvidia Tegra 3 SoC chugged along, having more than enough graphical power to take on the most demanding games, never mind regular day-to-day use. The Tegra 3 had four regular cores as well as a fifth 'stealth' core that took over processing needs during less intensive work, to maximize battery life. Speaking of battery life, the Nexus 7 packed a 4325 mAh battery which gave an impressive 9 and a half hours of regular use. Perhaps it was a jibe at Apple and their iPad ten hour battery life boasts but Asus engineers spent a lot of R&D time figuring out how to maximize battery life by testing each individual part of the PCB to prevent electrical leakage. The Nexus 7 was also the first device ever to ship with Android 4.1 Jelly Bean and was available in 8, 16 and 32 gig variants for the WiFi only model while the cellular model didn't have the 8 gig option. Several features were cut from the ME370T to make the \$199 price point however, such as the stylus.

The Nexus 7 was received very well, completely quashing it's main competitor the Kindle Fire and posing a strong challenge to the iPad. It just about trumped the Kindle Fire in every single category from the processor